YouthHackKC

SPONSORSHIP PROPOSAL

YouthHackKC Hackathon Spring 26

Developed By
Madhava Bhadriraju and Smayan Khot

Executive Summary

YouthHackKC is a fiscally sponsored nonprofit dedicated to expanding access to computer science education across the Kansas City Metro area for K–12 students. Through hackathons, tutoring programs, and workshops, we create hands-on opportunities for young people to go beyond learning how to code and start building things that matter.

Kansas City's youth face a real gap: while coding curricula and tutoring services exist, there are few structured environments where students can take that knowledge and apply it to real-world problems alongside peers, mentors, and industry professionals. YouthHackKC bridges that gap.

This spring, we are hosting our second hackathon, a 12-hour sprint for middle and high school students to build original technology projects, then pitch them to a panel of engineers and investors. We expect approximately 100 competitors to attend, making this our largest event to date.
We are seeking sponsors whose support will make this event possible, covering venue, food, prizes, and outreach, and whose brands will be front and center for the next generation of Kansas City's tech talent and their families.

Event and Organization Overview

ABOUT YHKC

YouthHackKC operates as a fiscally sponsored nonprofit project under HackClub Bank, which grants us tax-exempt 501(c)(3) status. Our primary programs are hackathons and tutoring sessions.

Our tutoring program has seen strong early demand: over 40 families have expressed interest, and we currently run asynchronous tutoring via Discord using CodeHS as our primary learning platform. As our programs grow, we are working to expand to more synchronous and in-person formats.

Our first hackathon was held at the Johnson County Corinth Library, where 30 students competed in an 8-hour event. Two guest speakers hosted workshops and served as judges for student presentations. Despite being our inaugural event with limited marketing reach, participation was strong, and it validated real demand in the community for this kind of experience.

HACKATHON SPRING 2026

Our second hackathon will be a 12-hour event hosted in the spring, with a target date in mid-May. The event will take place at the Johnson County Community College Capital Federal Conference Center, a significantly larger, more established venue than our first location, capable of supporting a much larger attendance.

The format is straightforward: students arrive, hear the theme, and have the entire day to build a product from scratch. At the end of the day, teams pitch their projects to a panel of judges, practicing real skills in both product development and presentation. Workshops led by industry professionals are woven throughout the day to provide mentorship and learning opportunities alongside the build period.

Event Schedule

Time	Activity
7:30 AM – 8:00 AM	Registration and Check-In
8:00 AM – 8:30 AM	Opening Session and Theme Announcement
8:00 AM – 10:00 AM	Light Breakfast
8:30 AM – 12:30 PM	Build Period + Workshops
12:30 PM – 1:00 PM	Lunch
1:00 PM – 6:00 PM	Build Period + Workshops
6:00 PM – 6:30 PM	Dinner
6:30 PM – 7:30 PM	Student Presentations and Judging
7:30 PM – 8:00 PM	Closing Ceremony and Awards

Expected Audience

Our past hackathon and tutoring programs have received much more attention from primarily younger students, including middle schoolers and late-elementary students. For this event, we expect a meaningful shift in that demographic for several reasons.

Venue and Network

First, the venue upgrade to JCCC's Capital Federal Conference Center lends the event a more professional feel that tends to attract more students from more backgrounds. Second, we are actively recruiting industry professionals to volunteer as mentors and judges, thereby raising the event's credibility and appeal to high schoolers seeking real networking opportunities.

Outreach Expansion

Our first hackathon relied almost entirely on Peachjar flyers distributed through our school district. For this event, we are building out a dedicated social media presence to reach high schoolers directly, as well as partnering with high school CS clubs, FIRST Robotics teams, and other STEM organizations across the Kansas City Metro to spread the word through peer networks and word-of-mouth effects.

We anticipate approximately **100 competitors,** representing a more than 3x growth from our first event, with a mix of middle schoolers, high schoolers, and potentially college students serving in volunteer or workshop roles. Furthermore, we are expecting around **10 industry professionals** who can support judging or workshop roles.

Expected Outcomes

- **100+ student competitors** from across the Kansas City Metro area in a structured, competitive learning experience.

- **20+ original technology projects** built and pitched in a single day, spanning categories like software applications, AI tools, hardware builds, and social impact solutions.

- **Meaningful skill development** across a range of disciplines, programming, product design, public speaking, teamwork, and rapid prototyping, for students who may not otherwise have exposure to these experiences.

- **Stronger community infrastructure for Kansas City youth** in STEM: new connections between students and local tech professionals, and a growing network of families, schools, and organizations invested in expanding CS access.

- **Documented impact shared with sponsors** post-event, including attendance figures, project summaries, demographic data, and feedback from participants and judges.

Event Budget

Item	Estimated Cost
Venue Booking (JCCC Cap Fed Center)	$1,200.00
Food Catering (3 meals × ~100 students × $10/meal)	$3,000.00
Prizes	$1,000.00
Outreach Costs (posters, banners, social media, domain)	$150.00
Insurance	$300.00
Emergency / Contingency Fund	$500.00
Swag	$350.00
Total Estimated Expenses	$6,500.00

Budget Notes

- **Venue**: The Johnson County Community College Capital Federal Conference Center charges $1,200 per day, which includes seating and all necessary equipment for an event of our size.

- **Food**: With approximately 100 competitors and three provided meals (breakfast, lunch, and dinner), we estimate a cost of $10 per meal per student, totaling $3,000. Providing full-day catering is important for keeping students on-site, focused, and energized throughout the 12-hour event.

- **Prizes**: The $500 prize pool is distributed across the top three placing teams: 1st place receives $500, 2nd place receives $300, and 3rd place receives $200. Sponsor-funded prize categories available at the Gold and Platinum tiers are additive to this base pool.

- **Outreach**: Covers the cost of printed promotional materials, including posters and banners for use at the event and in the community, annual domain and hosting fees for the YouthHackKC website, and miscellaneous social media advertising spend to reach students across the Kansas City Metro.

- **Insurance**: Standard event liability insurance is required to secure the venue and protect the organization and all participants throughout the event.

- **Emergency Fund**: A contingency reserve held for unexpected day-of costs: additional food needs, last-minute equipment, or other unforeseen circumstances.

- **Swag**: Participants will receive branded merchandise such as t-shirts and stickers. Sponsor logos will be included on all produced swag for eligible tiers.

- **All funds are managed through HackClub Bank under our 501(c)(3) fiscal sponsorship.** Sponsors will receive documentation confirming the tax-deductible nature of their contribution upon request.

Why Sponsor Us?

KC'S FUTURE

Every dollar you contribute goes directly toward giving young people in our community access to an experience that most students in major tech hubs take for granted. Hackathons build problem-solving instincts, collaboration skills, and the confidence to build things from scratch, and for many of our participants, this will be the first time they've ever had an opportunity like this. Kansas City has real technical talent waiting to be developed. YouthHackKC exists to make sure it is.

TALENT PIPELINE

The students who attend our hackathon today are the same students who will be choosing internships and careers in four to eight years. Sponsoring YouthHackKC puts your brand in front of them early, not through a job posting, but through a genuine investment in their growth. When a student spends a full day building something real while surrounded by your company's name and people, that association sticks.

DONE BEFORE

We're not asking you to bet on an unproven idea. We've hosted a hackathon, built a tutoring program, and grown an organization that operates with real fiscal accountability under our 501(c)(3) fiscal sponsorship through HackClub Bank. This sponsorship lets you scale what's already working and be part of what comes next. Here's some more about the organization's outreach performance:

- 40+ families reached for tutoring programs
- 30+ members at the first hackathon
- 80+ followers across social media pages
- Reached 30+ schools in the KCMO area.

TAX-DEDUCTIBLE

YouthHackKC is a fiscally sponsored project under HackClub Bank, a 501(c)(3) organization. Sponsorship contributions are tax-deductible to the extent permitted by law. We are happy to provide documentation upon request.

Sponsorship Tiers

Bronze Tier: $250

- Logo and name listed on the YouthHackKC website
- Name mentioned in all sponsor communications and emails to participants and families
- Inclusion in the official sponsor list distributed at the event
- Recognition as a community supporter of the hackathon

Silver Tier: $800

- **Silver includes all Bronze benefits, plus**
- Larger, more prominent logo placement on the website and in emails
- Dedicated social media shoutouts before and during the event
- Logo placement on participant swag (if produced)
- Logo featured in the opening and closing ceremony presentation slides

Gold Tier: $1500

- **Gold includes all Silver benefits, plus**
- Priority access to host a workshop, tech talk, or sponsored challenge during the hackathon
- Opportunity to brand a specific prize category (e.g., "Best AI Project: Sponsored by [Your Company]")
- Prominent logo placement across all event materials, signage, and printed collateral

Platinum Tier: $2500 (One Available)

- **Platinum includes all Gold benefits, plus**
- Headline sponsor status across all event branding
- Top-tier, largest logo placement on every piece of event material
- Guaranteed speaking opportunity during the opening ceremony
- Ability to present and name a custom prize category of your choosing
- A dedicated presence at the event (booth, table, or branded space)
- Repeated shoutouts throughout the day at the event and across all social media posts
- Post-event impact report sent directly to your team

Only one Platinum sponsorship is available. This tier is designed to create a true headline partner.

The Team

YouthHackKC is led by two co-founders who are both juniors at Blue Valley West High School in Overland Park, Kansas.

Madhava Bhadriraju, President: Madhava brings a combination of leadership experience and strong technical ability to YouthHackKC. With a background in computer science and a deep interest in entrepreneurship and finance, he has been the driving force behind the organization's growth from its founding through its first hackathon and beyond. Madhava is passionate about making the kinds of opportunities he has had in STEM accessible to every student in the Kansas City area, regardless of their school, background, or prior experience. LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/madhava-bhadriraju-0b135a278/

Smayan Khot, Vice President: Smayan is an engineering-focused student with a passion for building things and solving hard problems. As Vice President, he plays a key operational and logistical role in planning and executing YouthHackKC events. Smayan brings the same drive to YouthHackKC's mission that he brings to his own engineering pursuits, a belief that students learn best when they're challenged to build something real.

Both co-founders are avid hackathon participants themselves, and founded YouthHackKC out of a shared belief that the access and experiences they've had shouldn't be limited to a small group of students.

For sponsorship inquiries, please contact us directly. We would love to discuss how your organization can be part of this event.

- Madhava Bhadriraju (President): madhbhad@gmail.com
- Smayan Khot (Vice President): sskhot@bluevalleyk12.net

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